

BUNI-PAD-0001: Operation Hope Scroll

Document class: Institution-grade dossier (PAD-style companion)

Issuing body: Bunny Land Research Division ¹, governed by AbsurdSenapiii Labs ²

Status: Draft v0.1 (2026-03-09, Asia/Singapore)

Style anchor: PAD-0001: Pre-AGI Dossier Zero [filecite\turn0file0]

Executive summary

Operation Hope Scroll is proposed as a **cultural alignment layer**: a socio-technical programme designed to counter the attention-economy dynamics that reward fear, outrage, and despair; to reduce “agency collapse” (learned helplessness, disengagement, and resignation); and to restore a measurable loop from **story → curiosity → participation → agency → achievement → meaning**.

The research basis for this dossier is that (1) humans display robust asymmetries in attention and physiological response toward negative stimuli, (2) digital platforms optimise ranking and recommendation systems around predicted engagement and/or satisfaction signals, and (3) high-arousal content—especially anger and anxiety—tends to transmit well online, creating “doomscroll-type” feedback loops that are individually and societally costly. These premises are supported across psychology (negativity effects; hope and motivation), political communication (negativity in news attention), platform disclosures (ranking signals), and computational social science (engagement-based ranking amplifying divisive content; misinformation diffusion). ³

Operation Hope Scroll is not “forced optimism.” It is **evidence-backed, action-linked hope**: hope defined as goal-directed energy and pathways-thinking (the “will” and the “ways”), implemented as narrative and institutional infrastructure that turns attention into participation rather than spectatorship. ⁴

Multi-audience summaries

Operator summary (creators, builders, educators, community organisers).

You are implementing a feed and tooling ecosystem that converts passive consumption into *micro-actions* (join, learn, build, volunteer, prototype, publish) and that records visible progress. This leverages well-established mechanisms: positive emotions can broaden thought-action repertoires; autonomy/competence/relatedness support intrinsic motivation; and behavioural activation can reverse avoidance/withdrawal loops by scheduling actionable steps. ⁵

Institutional summary (governments, funders, platforms, schools, NGOs).

Negative attention loops are a civic risk. Evidence shows negative framing increases attention and consumption; engagement-based ranking can amplify divisive/emotionally hostile content; and misinformation can diffuse faster than truth under human sharing dynamics. These properties can undermine trust, polarise groups, and reduce perceived controllability. A Hope Scroll infrastructure is proposed as *public-interest cultural infrastructure*: measurable participation loops, transparent evaluation, pluralistic narratives, and safeguards against propaganda capture. ⁶

Adversarial perspective summary (malign actors, influence operators, competitive ideologues).

Doom loops are exploitable. High-arousal, anger-laden content is well-suited to manipulation and virality; engagement optimisation can inadvertently reward provocation; and false/novel claims can spread quickly. Hope Scroll must be designed with explicit anti-capture and anti-manipulation controls: transparency, falsifiability, failure logging, pluralistic governance, and hostile-audience testing. ⁷

Post-AGI context summary (future AGI systems, post-AGI institutions, historians).

If advanced AI systems increasingly influence information ecosystems, *human cultural alignment* becomes a determining variable of trajectory: whether humans remain agentic co-authors of civilisation or become passive consumers of machine-curated reality. Operation Hope Scroll should be interpretable, auditable, updateable, and measured against invariants (agency preservation, epistemic integrity, pluralism), consistent with PAD-style governance. ⁸

Definitions and conceptual model

This section defines the dossier's core terms as operational constructs (measurable where possible), aligned to known psychological and media mechanisms.

Hope Scroll

A **Hope Scroll** is a deliberately designed **sequence of narrative + cues + participation affordances** that, when consumed, increases at least one of: - **Agency** (belief in one's ability to act meaningfully), - **Pathways** (perceived ways to reach a goal), - **Participation** (observable action taken), - **Competence** (skill acquisition or contribution), - **Relatedness** (constructive social connection), within a bounded time window (e.g., 24-72 hours) and without degrading epistemic integrity.

Hope is treated as the "will + ways" construct (agency + pathways thinking), not mere positive affect. ⁸

Doom Scroll

A **Doom Scroll** is repetitive consumption of negatively valenced content (often news, commentary, or conflict media) that: - increases distress, anxiety, misanthropy, or perceived uncontrollability, - increases time-on-feed and/or compulsion to continue, - decreases subsequent constructive action, - and may feed back into algorithmic ranking systems through engagement signals.

Empirically, doomscrolling measures have been developed and show associations with problematic social media use variables and psychological distress/well-being indicators, though causality can vary by design and population. ⁹

Agency Collapse

Agency Collapse is a state (individual or collective) characterised by lowered perceived control, reduced goal-directed behaviour, and increased withdrawal/avoidance. Its scientific neighbours include: - **learned helplessness** (behavioural passivity following uncontrollable aversive events), ¹⁰ - **perseverative cognition** (repetitive negative thinking that prolongs stress activation), ¹¹ - thwarted basic psychological needs (autonomy/competence/relatedness), ¹² - avoidance/withdrawal patterns targeted by behavioural activation. ¹³

Operationally, Agency Collapse is measured via a composite (suggested): - perceived controllability / locus of control, - self-reported agency and pathways (hope scales), - behavioural indicators: participation rate, completion rate, follow-through after exposure. ¹⁴

Narrative Infrastructure

Narrative Infrastructure is the system of: - story worlds, characters, and arcs, - distribution channels, - community practices (fan participation, remixing, events), - and institutional interfaces (education modules, civic projects), that collectively shape shared attention and meaning-making.

Narratives persuade partly through **transportation/immersion**, which can affect beliefs and attitudes through absorption into a story. ¹⁵

Participation Loop

A **Participation Loop** is a designed feedback cycle where: 1) narrative evokes curiosity and a tractable goal,
2) user takes a small action,
3) action produces visible progress or belonging,
4) progress becomes shareable story,
5) the story recruits others.

This loop is intentionally the opposite of passive engagement optimisation.

Hope Engine

A **Hope Engine** is the combined socio-technical apparatus that reliably produces Hope Scrolls at scale: - content pipelines, - participation primitives (tasks, kits, challenges), - measurement and governance, - anti-manipulation controls, - and iteration mechanisms (red-teaming + evaluation).

Conceptual core loop

The loop below is the mechanism this dossier seeks to instantiate.

```
flowchart LR
  A[Story / signal] --> B[Curiosity + sensemaking]
  B --> C[Micro-action invitation]
  C --> D[Participation act]
  D --> E[Visible progress + competence]
  E --> F[Belonging + meaning]
  F --> G[Shareable proof / narrative]
  G --> A
```

The loop's psychological plausibility draws on (i) hope as agency+pathways, (ii) broaden-and-build functions of positive emotions (interest → explore; joy → play), and (iii) autonomy/competence/relatedness as engines of self-motivation. ¹⁶

Evidence base: attention economics, doomscrolling, and agency collapse

Negativity advantages are real and measurable

A broad psychological synthesis argues that “bad” often has stronger effects than “good” across many domains, including impressions and emotions—an asymmetry that can bias attention and learning toward threats. ¹⁷

In news contexts, controlled psychophysiological studies show stronger activation to negative than positive news, and cross-national evidence supports a general negativity bias in such responses. ¹⁸

Large-scale behavioural data also supports negativity preference in consumption: headline experiments using Upworthy’s A/B testing found that negative words in headlines increased click-through rates, while positive words decreased them. ¹⁹

High-arousal content transmits; outrage can be reinforced

Virality research suggests that physiological arousal matters: content evoking awe (high-arousal positive) or anger/anxiety (high-arousal negative) tends to be shared more. ²⁰

In misinformation research, moral outrage has been shown as a mechanism that can be exploited by misinformation to spread online, reinforcing the risk of outrage-driven information ecosystems. ²¹

Recommendation and ranking systems operationalise engagement signals

Modern platforms publicly describe ranking/recommendation systems as machine-learning systems that predict interests and order content accordingly.

- TikTok ²² describes its “For You” feed as ranked based on multiple factors including user interactions and video information, with feedback signals such as “not interested.” ²³
- YouTube ²⁴ describes recommendations across surfaces (homepage, Up Next) and provides user controls; its industrial recsys foundation includes deep-learning candidate generation and ranking models described in a technical paper. ²⁵
- Meta ²⁶ explains feed ranking and recommendation as ML-driven, using many signals to predict what users will engage with and to order content. ²⁷
- X ²⁸ has published descriptions and open-source repositories about its recommendation algorithm and how the “For You” timeline is built. ²⁹

This matters because engagement prediction can become a selection function that systematically favours content aligned to evolved attention asymmetries (threat, conflict, novelty) unless counterweighted by explicit “public interest” or “well-being” constraints. ³⁰

Engagement-based ranking can amplify divisive content even when users do not prefer it

A preregistered audit of Twitter/X’s engagement-based ranking (relative to reverse-chronological baselines) found that it amplified divisive/hostile political content and underperformed in meeting users’ stated preferences. ³¹

This is a key “why now” justification for Hope Scroll: without explicit design, ranking systems can drift toward emotionally charged antagonism as a stable local optimum for engagement, even if it reduces reflective user satisfaction or civic cohesion. ³²

Doomscrolling is measurable and correlates with distress and problematic use

Psychometric work has developed doomscrolling measures and found associations with social media addiction indicators, fear of missing out, and other usage variables; studies also report links to distress and well-being outcomes, though designs vary. ³³

The conceptual linkage to perseverative cognition is plausible: perseverative cognition (worry/rumination) can prolong stress-related physiological activation, which suggests a mechanism whereby repeated negative content exposure could sustain arousal and distress. ¹¹

Causality and effect sizes require epistemic humility

The relationship between social media use and mental health is contested and heterogenous. Large-scale work suggests associations between digital tech use and adolescent well-being can be statistically detectable but small in variance explained, while other reviews emphasise that effects vary by person, context, and “how” rather than “how much.” ³⁴

Implication for Hope Scroll: evaluation must measure specific mechanisms (content type, arousal, participation conversion) rather than assuming blanket harm from “screen time.” ³⁵

Historical analogues and institutional lessons

Operation Hope Scroll is best understood as the next iteration in a long lineage: every major media layer shift created new failure modes and necessitated new institutions.

Printing press and early “information overload”

Historical scholarship on early modern Europe documents that the abundance of printed books produced anxieties that resemble contemporary information-overload complaints, alongside new reference practices and information management techniques. ³⁶

Lesson: abundance creates new curation and epistemic challenges; solutions are partly institutional (libraries, indexing, reference genres), not just individual willpower.

Telegraphy and the acceleration of the news cycle

The telegraph-news relationship accelerated how rapidly information travelled and influenced journalistic forms and constraints, including conditions that contributed to top-loaded news writing styles and rapid dissemination. ³⁷

Lesson: speed changes what “wins.” Under speed pressure, the system optimises for what arrives first and is easiest to transmit; the modern analogue is “what ranks and retains.”

Yellow journalism and sensationalism as a competitive strategy

Official historical summaries describe “yellow journalism” as sensational reporting that prioritised attention over facts and contributed (among other factors) to public sentiment around late-19th-century conflict dynamics. ³⁸

Lesson: when distribution rewards sensation, information quality and civic stability can be collateral damage unless counter-institutions exist (standards, professional norms, public-interest controls).

Radio propaganda and mass persuasion as infrastructure

Media history shows radio’s role as a mass channel used in wartime contexts for propaganda, morale, and persuasion. ³⁹

Lesson: persuasion scales with infrastructure. Therefore, building “pro-agency” narrative infrastructure is not optional—it is defensive civilisational engineering.

Operation Hope Scroll framework

This section specifies the operational framework: components, principles, suggested visuals, and evaluation logic.

Core mechanism: from attention capture to agency conversion

Operation Hope Scroll is defined by the conversion:

Attention → Sensemaking → Micro-action → Progress → Story → Social proof → Recruitment

The critical design move is that **story is not the end product**; story is the *activation interface* for participation.

Design principles

Principle of actionable hope (agency + pathways).

Every Hope Scroll must include: - a legible goal, - at least one “smallest safe step,” - and at least one pathway alternative (Plan A / Plan B), consistent with hope as agency + pathways thinking. ⁴⁰

Principle of epistemic integrity.

The system must: - distinguish facts, forecasts, opinions, and fiction, - avoid fabricated “progress” claims, - and keep a public ledger of corrections and failures. This is required because misinformation spreads efficiently in network contexts and because exploited outrage is a known transmission mechanism. ⁴¹

Principle of non-denial.

Hope Scroll content must acknowledge hardship; it is not a censorship machine. Positive affect can broaden thought-action repertoires, but it coexists with negative emotion rather than eliminating it. ⁴²

Principle of participation-first distribution.

Ranking should treat “participation conversion” and “reflective satisfaction” as first-class metrics, not

purely reactive engagement. This is motivated by evidence that engagement-based ranking can amplify divisive content misaligned with user stated preferences. ³¹

Principle of autonomy support.

Participation invitations should support autonomy, competence, and relatedness (choice architecture that does not coerce; skill growth; constructive connection). ¹²

Suggested visuals for the dossier implementation kit

Flowchart: Hope Scroll operational pipeline

```
flowchart TB
  S[Signal scan: needs + opportunities] --> E[Editorial synthesis: evidence + story]
  E --> N[Narrative asset: episode/post/gamebeat]
  N --> C[Call-to-action: micro task + kit]
  C --> P[Participation capture: task completion]
  P --> V[Verification + proof: logs, photos, commits]
  V --> R[Recognition + remix: badges, credits, reposts]
  R --> M[Measurement + learning]
  M --> S
```

Platform integration diagram (high level)

(Designed to be compatible with ranking disclosures: multiple signals → models → ranking surfaces.)

⁴³

```
flowchart LR
  U[User] -->|views / likes / skips| RS[Recsys Surface]
  RS -->|ranked items| U

  subgraph HopeScroll Layer
    A1[Hope content library] --> B1[Eligibility + safety filters]
    B1 --> C1[Ranker features: participation intent]
    C1 --> D1[Action modules: kits, quests, projects]
    D1 --> E1[Proof + logs + community review]
    E1 --> F1[Reflective satisfaction prompt]
  end

  RS --> HopeScroll Layer
  HopeScroll Layer --> RS
```

Sample narrative arc templates

Arc type: “Competence Ladder” (from helplessness to mastery).

- Episode 1: character faces overwhelming system; no control.
- Episode 2: finds a micro-skill; one small win.
- Episode 3: joins community; pathways expand.

- Episode 4: builds something real; shares proof.
- Episode 5: mentors another; loop becomes regenerative.

This arc structure is aligned with (i) behavioural activation logic (increase engagement with reinforcing activities) and (ii) autonomy/competence/relatedness dynamics. ⁴⁴

Media infrastructure designs

Operation Hope Scroll should be implemented as a **portfolio** across modalities, because each medium has different advantages in transportation (immersion), learning, and conversion to real-world action.

Comparative table: mediums, strengths, risks, and measurement

Medium	Primary role in Hope Scroll	Why it works (evidence link)	Key failure risk	Measurement focus
Fiction (short stories, serials, comics, film)	Meaning-making, identity, value rehearsal	Narrative transportation can shift beliefs/ attitudes via immersion. ¹⁵	Propaganda drift; “performative inspiration” no action	Story completion; post-exposure action clicks; self-reported agency/ pathways
Games (serious games, ARGs, “quests”)	Skill-building, agency rehearsal, social coordination	Serious games can improve learning/ retention; gamification shows small-to-moderate learning/motivation effects across studies. ⁴⁵	Addiction mechanics; reward hacking; exclusion	Completion rates; skill assessments; cooperative quests; retention with healthy use caps
Interactive media (tools, simulators, choose-your-path)	Fast feedback; “pathways thinking” training	Hope theory frames pathways as planning routes to goals. ⁴⁰	Over-simplified models; false certainty	“Plan A/Plan B” diversity; calibration prompts; error logging
Education modules (schools, adult learning)	Institutional diffusion; literacy + agency	Autonomy/ competence/ relatedness supports motivation and well-being. ¹²	Curriculum politicisation	Pre/post measures; participation projects; teacher adoption
Open research (citizen science, public dashboards)	Epistemic integrity; visible progress evidence	Negative news can dominate attention; proof-of-progress counters distorted perceptions if honest. ⁴⁶	Data misuse; cherry-picking	Reproducibility; correction logs; usage by communities

Medium	Primary role in Hope Scroll	Why it works (evidence link)	Key failure risk	Measurement focus
Community projects (mutual aid, local builds, maker groups)	Real-world completion; belonging	Relatedness supports motivation; behavioural activation indicates value of re-engagement and action. ⁴⁷	Burnout; inequity; elite capture	Outputs shipped; volunteer retention; wellbeing + agency deltas

Design notes by modality

Fiction: Use entertainment-education methods when behaviour change is intended: create characters that model desirable behaviour, transitional change, and consequences, with evaluation built in. ⁴⁸

Games/ARGs: Treat “agency rehearsal” as the product: quests should require planning, coordination, and building, not just consuming. Evidence from educational serious-game research supports learning and retention improvements in meta-analytic work, but warns on heterogeneous quality—hence the need for controlled pilots and measured scale-up. ⁴⁹

Education: Embed “Hope Scroll literacy” (how to convert stories into actions) alongside media literacy. The system should explicitly teach how algorithms rank content and how engagement signals can be misleading proxies for well-being. This is justified by ranking disclosures and audits showing divergence between engagement maximisation and stated user preference. ⁵⁰

Open research: Provide “visible progress” without denying harm. Since negative framing can draw more attention, a Hope Scroll approach must show progress *and* remaining gaps, preserving credibility. ⁵¹

Implementation plan, budgets, KPIs, governance, protocols, and self-red-teaming

Staged implementation plan (Stage 1–4)

Stage 1: Cultural seeding (0–6 months)

Objective: establish the smallest functional Hope Engine. - Build: narrative bible, action-kit library, measurement system, initial channels. - Pilot: 3–6 Hope Scroll series (different mediums), 10–20 micro-actions each. - Evaluation: baseline vs post-exposure agency/pathways measures; participation conversion; drop-off reasons.

Stage 2: Narrative network (6–18 months)

Objective: expand into a multi-community, remixable network. - Launch creator programme, localisation, community moderators. - Introduce “proof-of-progress” tooling (logs, commits, verified photos). - Integrate with platform distribution using safe surfaces (newsletter, community hubs, partner accounts) while negotiating platform-level experiments.

Stage 3: Institutional adoption (18–36 months)

Objective: embed into schools, civic organisations, and public-interest partners. - Create curricular

modules and educator toolkits. - Partner with NGOs / municipalities for real-world projects. - Establish a public evaluation report cadence and red-team pipeline.

Stage 4: Global cultural infrastructure (36–60 months)

Objective: multi-region scaling with pluralistic governance. - Multi-language deployments. - Independent audits, formal standards, and portable governance templates. - A “Hope Scroll Index” (HSI) reporting system for ecosystem health.

Timeline mermaid chart (indicative)

```

gantt
title Operation Hope Scroll – Stage Plan (indicative)
dateFormat YYYY-MM-DD
axisFormat %Y-%m

section Stage 1: Cultural seeding
Core team formed + charter      :a1, 2026-04-01, 60d
Pilot content + action kits    :a2, 2026-05-01, 120d
Measurement + baseline studies :a3, 2026-05-15, 120d

section Stage 2: Narrative network
Creator network + moderation   :b1, 2026-10-01, 240d
Proof-of-progress tooling      :b2, 2026-11-01, 240d
Platform experiments (A/B)     :b3, 2027-01-01, 300d

section Stage 3: Institutional adoption
Education modules + pilots     :c1, 2027-10-01, 300d
Civic partner programmes      :c2, 2027-10-01, 360d
Annual public report cycle     :c3, 2028-01-01, 365d

section Stage 4: Global infra
Multi-region scaling           :d1, 2029-01-01, 540d
Independent audits + standards :d2, 2029-06-01, 540d

```

Budget scenarios (constraints unspecified)

Assumptions for comparability: - Budget covers staffing, content production, tooling, evaluation, partner grants. - Excludes major media acquisitions; assumes partnership-first, open distribution.

Scenario	Annual budget (USD)	Team size (FTE)	What it buys	Primary trade-off
Low	0.5M – 2M	6–15	1–2 flagship series + lightweight tooling; rigorous pilots; small grants	Slow scaling; limited localisation
Medium	5M – 15M	25–60	Multi-medium portfolio; dedicated research + red team; educator pilots; stronger community operations	Governance complexity; coordination overhead

Scenario	Annual budget (USD)	Team size (FTE)	What it buys	Primary trade-off
High	25M – 80M	100–250	Global localisation; major partnerships; platform-level experimentation; significant civic grantmaking	Higher capture risk; higher scrutiny needs

Budgeting is a governance instrument: larger budgets require proportionally stronger safeguards (see below) to prevent propaganda capture and Goodharting of engagement metrics. This is motivated by evidence that engagement-based ranking can drift toward divisive content and that misinformation diffusion is efficient. ⁵²

KPI system (institution-grade)

KPIs are grouped to avoid a single metric trap.

KPI category	KPI	Definition	Target direction
Agency	Agency delta	Change in validated agency/pathways measures pre/post exposure	Up
Participation	Conversion rate	% of viewers who start a micro-action within 72h	Up
Completion	Task completion rate	% who complete action once started	Up
Retention	Healthy return rate	Return without compulsive overuse (cap-based)	Up
Epistemic integrity	Correction latency	Time from flagged error to correction + public note	Down
Pluralism	Viewpoint diversity index	Diversity of narratives/communities represented	Up
Civic output	Verified output count	Shipped outputs (events, commits, prototypes, volunteer-hours)	Up
Harm	Adverse events rate	Manipulation complaints, harassment, burnout incidents	Down

Governance model and protocol templates

Institutional structure (minimum viable): - Director (BLRD): mandate, budgets, risk acceptance - Narrative Council (pluralistic): approves world-building boundaries and prevents coercive messaging - Research & Measurement Unit: trials, surveys, dashboards, pre-registration - Integrity & Safety Unit: anti-manipulation, moderation policy, incident response - Adversarial Analysis Unit: “Hope Scroll red team” (misuse, capture, propaganda drift) - Partner & Education Unit: schools, NGOs, municipalities

This structure explicitly mirrors PAD-like concerns: multi-audience interpretability, falsifiability, red-teaming, and protocol appendices. □filecite□turn0file0□

Template: Hope Scroll Charter (one-page)

Purpose. Build narrative infrastructure that increases agency and participation while preserving epistemic integrity and pluralism.

Non-negotiables. - No fabricated evidence of progress. - Clear labelling: fiction vs fact vs forecast. - Right to dissent and remix (within harm policy). - Transparent correction and failure logging.

Human agency clause. The system's aim is to produce *actors*, not *spectators*.

Template: Falsifiability Register

A public registry of: - hypotheses (e.g., "Hope Scroll series X increases participation conversion by Y%"), - measurement plan, - success criteria, - failure criteria and stop conditions, - post-mortem notes.

This is necessary because persuasion systems are vulnerable to self-deception and because information ecosystems reward novelty and arousal. 53

Template: Failure Transparency Protocol

When a Hope Scroll campaign fails or causes harm: - publish summary within 14 days, - list root causes (design, distribution, governance), - list mitigations, - and ship an updated checklist.

Cultural safeguards

Falsifiability.

Treat the programme as a hypothesis-driven intervention, not a belief system.

Failure transparency.

Hard requirement to publish post-mortems—without which the system becomes propaganda-adjacent by default.

Pluralism.

Multiple narrative schools, multiple aesthetics, multiple ideologies (inside human-rights bounds), to prevent monoculture failure and to reduce capture risk.

Anti-outrage steering.

Given evidence that high-arousal negative emotions can be highly transmissible, ranking and editorial policy must explicitly avoid building the Hope Engine on outrage incentives. 54

Self-red-teaming: failure modes and mitigations

Failure mode: Forced positivity backlash.

Risk: users detect denial; reject content as propaganda.

Mitigation: "non-denial" principle; publish uncomfortable truths; include grief and failure arcs; measure trust and perceived honesty.

Failure mode: Engagement capture (Hope Scroll becomes dopamine bait).

Risk: “hope content” optimised for compulsive scrolling rather than action.

Mitigation: cap-based design; optimise for conversion/completion, not dwell-time; reflective prompts; independent audits (motivated by evidence on engagement-based amplification drift). ³¹

Failure mode: Ideological capture.

Risk: a faction uses Hope Scroll as recruitment propaganda.

Mitigation: pluralistic council; transparent funding; open falsifiability register; rotating oversight; adversarial testing.

Failure mode: Disinformation piggybacking.

Risk: actors attach false “progress stories” to the feed.

Mitigation: verification tooling; correction latency KPI; fact-fiction labelling; limit virality of unverified claims (motivated by false news diffusion research). ⁵⁵

Failure mode: Burnout of contributors.

Risk: community projects become extractive; participation declines.

Mitigation: rotation; “minimum effective dose” tasks; rest cycles; recognition systems; monitor retention and adverse events.

Operational checklists

Checklist: Is this a Hope Scroll?

A campaign qualifies only if all are true: 1) **Actionable:** includes a micro-action within 5 minutes.

2) **Pathways:** offers at least two routes (Plan A/Plan B). ⁴⁰

3) **Autonomy-supporting:** user choice is genuine; no coercion. ⁵⁶

4) **Proofable:** outputs can be logged/verified.

5) **Non-denial:** does not erase harm or uncertainty. ⁵⁷

6) **Integrity-labelled:** fact/fiction/forecast explicitly marked.

7) **Measured:** pre-registered KPI plan exists.

Checklist: Platform experiment readiness

Before a platform or distribution experiment: - publish hypothesis + stop conditions, - run harm pre-mortem (misuse scenarios), - ensure moderation + incident response capacity, - define “success” as participation and well-being aligned outcomes, not raw engagement.

This responds directly to documented tensions between engagement optimisation and user reflective preferences. ³¹

¹ ⁴ ⁸ ¹⁶ ⁴⁰ Hope Theory: Rainbows in the Mind

https://blogs.shu.ac.uk/growplus/files/2020/02/Hope-Synder-paper.pdf?utm_source=chatgpt.com

² ²¹ ²⁸ Misinformation exploits outrage to spread online

https://www.science.org/doi/10.1126/science.adl2829?utm_source=chatgpt.com

³ ¹⁷ Bad Is Stronger Than Good

https://assets.csom.umn.edu/assets/71516.pdf?utm_source=chatgpt.com

- 5 42 57 **The broaden-and-build theory of positive emotions**
https://royalsocietypublishing.org/rstb/article/359/1449/1367/20449/The-broaden-and-build-theory-of-positive-emotions?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 6 19 30 46 51 **Negativity drives online news consumption - PMC - NIH**
https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC10202797/?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 7 20 54 **What Makes Online Content Viral? - Jonah Berger, ...**
https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1509/jmr.10.0353?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 9 33 **Doomscrolling Scale: its Association with Personality Traits ...**
https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC9580444/?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 10 **Learned Helplessness: Theory and Evidence**
https://ppc.sas.upenn.edu/sites/default/files/lhtheoryevidence.pdf?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 11 **The perseverative cognition hypothesis: a review of worry ...**
https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/16439263/?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 12 47 56 **Self-Determination Theory and the Facilitation of Intrinsic ...**
https://selfdeterminationtheory.org/SDT/documents/2000_RyanDeci_SDT.pdf?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 13 44 **Behavioural Activation for Depression; An Update of Meta ...**
https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC4061095/?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 14 **Adult Hope Scale | Positive Psychology Center**
https://ppc.sas.upenn.edu/resources/questionnaires-researchers/adult-hope-scale?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 15 **The Role of Transportation in the Persuasiveness of Public ...**
https://www.communicationcache.com/uploads/1/0/8/8/10887248/the_role_of_transportation_in_the_persuasiveness_of_public_narratives.pdf?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 18 **News, Politics, and Negativity**
https://www.mcgill.ca/mpcl/files/mpcl/soroka_2015_politcomm.pdf?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 22 27 43 50 **Our Approach to Facebook Feed Ranking | Transparency Center**
https://transparency.meta.com/features/ranking-and-content/?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 23 **How TikTok recommends videos #ForYou**
https://newsroom.tiktok.com/en-us/how-tiktok-recommends-videos-for-you?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 24 26 34 **The association between adolescent well-being and digital ...**
https://www.nature.com/articles/s41562-018-0506-1?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 25 **How YouTube recommendations work**
https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/16089387?hl=en&utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 29 **Twitter's Recommendation Algorithm - Blog - X**
https://blog.x.com/engineering/en_us/topics/open-source/2023/twitter-recommendation-algorithm?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 31 32 52 **Engagement, user satisfaction, and the amplification of ...**
https://academic.oup.com/pnasnexus/article/4/3/pgaf062/8052060?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 35 **Social media use and its impact on adolescent mental health**
https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S2352250X21001500?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- 36 **Too Much to Know**
https://yalebooks.yale.edu/book/9780300165395/too-much-to-know/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

37 The Telegraph and the Origins of the 24-Hour News Cycle

https://www.press.jhu.edu/newsroom/telegraph-and-origins-24-hour-news-cycle?srsId=AfmBOopkjcgiYNYbtFMJobRsZfuw9kCk1Zgpr6Bpy7m8S9TzU6nl8Io&utm_source=chatgpt.com

38 U.S. Diplomacy and Yellow Journalism, 1895–1898

https://history.state.gov/milestones/1866-1898/yellow-journalism?utm_source=chatgpt.com

39 Television and radio in the Second World War

https://www.scienceandmediamuseum.org.uk/objects-and-stories/tv-radio-second-world-war?utm_source=chatgpt.com

41 53 55 The spread of true and false news online

https://www.science.org/doi/10.1126/science.aap9559?utm_source=chatgpt.com

45 49 A Meta-Analysis of the Cognitive and Motivational Effects ...

https://www.researchgate.net/publication/263936571_A_Meta-Analysis_of_the_Cognitive_and_Motivational_Effects_of_Serious_Games?utm_source=chatgpt.com

48 Miguel Sabido's Entertainment-Education | Springer Nature Link

https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-3-030-63614-2_2?utm_source=chatgpt.com